

As the Dalai Lama reached his teenage years, he still lived a sheltered life in the palace, but he was becoming more curious about the world outside Tibet. He heard that a mountain climber from Austria, named Heinrich Harrer, was visiting Tibet. The Dalai Lama wanted to meet this daring explorer, so he asked him to visit the palace. Harrer tutored him in history, science, and geography. He was happy to answer many of the Dalai Lama's curious questions.



Heinrich Harrer

The Tibetans had first seen him as a little boy arriving in Lhasa. But as the Dalai Lama grew older, he was learning how to become a leader. He watched and learned from his government advisors at the palace. His studies with the monks taught him the values of Buddhism. And his time alone and sheltered from others had trained him to think deeply and meditate on ideas of leadership and compassion. All these things were